



UT Dallas 2025 Undergraduate Catalog

Undergraduate Policies and Procedures

Degree Plans

A degree plan is a definition of the course of study necessary to fulfill the requirement for graduation. A degree plan is "major specific" and is established through collaboration between the student and the academic advisor for the student's major. Course changes within university sanctioned degree plans may be made with the approval of the Associate Dean of Undergraduate Education (ADU) or his or her designee. An initial degree plan must be filed as soon as possible after entering the major. Per State legislation effective fall semester 2012, all entering freshman students must file a degree plan no later than the end of the second regular semester following the semester in which the student earned 45 or more semester credit hours in accordance with *Texas Education Code*, Section 51.9685. The initial degree plan will be kept in the office of the academic advisor, ADU, or program head and will form the basis of the student's advisement.

In the semester preceding that in which a student plans to graduate the student is required to meet with her/his academic advisor to prepare a final degree plan along with the student's application for graduation (See "[Graduation Requirements](#)" for more information).

NOTE: A change of major requires preparation of a new degree plan.

Change of Major

Newly admitted students can request change of major after Census Day of their first term of enrollment. Students wishing to change majors must submit a request by completing the "Undergraduate Online Change of Plan" in their Orion Student Center. The Associate Dean of Undergraduate Education will evaluate the student's academic record to determine the potential for success in the new major and process the request accordingly. Please note that the Associate Dean of Undergraduate Education may review the student's UT Dallas academic record in order to evaluate the request.

Students with a cumulative GPA (grade point average) below 2.000 may only change their major only with permission from the Associate Dean of their current major and the Associate Dean of their intended major. Both Associate Deans' approvals are required on the "Undergraduate Online Change of Plan."

All students are allowed to modify their major twice during their academic career at no charge. A modification is defined as a change, addition, or deletion of a major to a student's academic plan. A student's academic career begins the first class day of the first semester of enrollment at UT Dallas.

If a student elects to modify his/her major more than two times during an academic career, the third modification requires a \$50.00 fee. EXCEPTION: There is no charge to move from the "exploratory and pre-major" category.

If the change of major is approved, the student will then be responsible for meeting all program requirements and course prerequisites of the catalog in effect at the time of the change. The Core Curriculum requirements, however, remain those of the catalog in force at the time of matriculation unless the student specifically chooses those of a more recent catalog. In the first semester of change to a new major, the student must meet with an academic advisor to prepare a degree plan.

Students wishing to change to an ECS major should review the [ECS Policy on Undergraduate Change of Majors](#)

Students wishing to change to an IS Healthcare Studies major should review the [IS Policy on Healthcare Studies Change of Majors](#)

Students wishing to change to a JSOM major should review the [JSOM Policy on Undergraduate Change of Majors](#)

Deadlines and Fees

The Office of the Registrar will accept the approved "Undergraduate Online Change of Plan" in their Orion Student Center for processing up to the close of business on the first day of classes of each semester. Forms received after the first day of classes will be processed effective for the following semester.

All students are allowed to modify their major twice during their academic career at no charge. A modification is defined as a change, addition, or deletion of a major to a student's academic plan. A student's academic career begins the first class day of the first semester of enrollment at UT Dallas.

If a student elects to modify his/her major more than two times during an academic career, the third modification requires a \$50.00 fee. EXCEPTION: There is no charge to move from the "exploratory and pre-major" categories.

Declaring a Major

Undergraduate students must declare an academic course of study or major by the time they have earned 54 semester credit hours in order to continue enrollment. These semester credit hours include UT Dallas credits, credit transferred from other institutions, and semester credit hours awarded through [credit by examination](#) (AP, CLEP, IB, A/AS Levels).

Transfer students who have earned 54 semester credit hours at the time they apply for admission to UT Dallas may be exploratory for one semester. After the initial semester these students must then declare a major or change to pre-major to be allowed to register for a subsequent semester.

Continuing students on academic probation who pass the 54 semester credit hour benchmark without declaring a major have a maximum of two long semesters to regain good academic standing. During this period students will be required to change to pre-major. A student who fails to regain good standing within two long-semesters will be suspended from the University.

Double Major and Double Degree

Students should consult their advisors and/or primary school to learn more about double majors or double degrees. Additional information can be found at "[Other Degree Requirements](#)."

A student may earn a double major or a double degree but not both. A second baccalaureate student may not double major, seek a double degree, or change majors without a new admission application.

Updated: 2025-05-25 18:27:32 v3.a94bff